

# Rajesh Dammala

## Engineering Manager — Site Reliability & Software Systems

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Morrisville, NC · Open to Relocation / Hybrid / Remote

[https://rdammala.github.io/Google\\_Engineering-Manager-SRE/](https://rdammala.github.io/Google_Engineering-Manager-SRE/)

## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

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Engineering manager and senior technical leader with 16+ years across software engineering and site reliability for large-scale distributed systems. Grows and manages global teams of 15-32 engineers — owning hiring, performance, mentoring, and career development — while setting technical direction for architecture, reliability, and automation. Defines SLIs/SLOs and error-budget practice, owns incident/problem management, on-call strategy, capacity planning, and post-incident reviews, and reduces toil through software engineering in Python/PowerShell with CI/CD and IaC. Architected AI-driven incident automation (30-35% auto-resolution), cut MTTR 32%, eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents, and sustained 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services. Trusted cross-functional partner and executive communicator.

## CAREER SNAPSHOT

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**16+** Years in IT / Cloud / Reliability Engineering  
**100%** SLA Across 20+ Mission-Critical Services  
**30-35%** Incidents Auto-Resolved via AI Automation  
**25,000+** Stale Incidents Eliminated  
**85%!'98%** Operational Efficiency Lift  
**15-32** Engineers Led Across Global Teams

## KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

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- Led and grew global teams of 15-32 engineers (US + India) — hiring, mentoring, and career development — sustaining 100% SLA across 20+ mission-critical services.
- Set technical direction for reliability and automation; defined SLIs/SLOs, owned incident/problem management, on-call, capacity planning, and post-incident reviews.
- Architected AI-driven incident automation reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; cut MTTR 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Reduced toil through software engineering — Python/PowerShell tools eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ noisy alerts (~90% alert-fatigue reduction).
- Partnered cross-functionally with R&D, product, and security to land complex multi-team initiatives; authored 175+ runbooks and grew ICs into technical leads.

## TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

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**Engineering Leadership:** Team Management (15-32 engineers), Hiring & Career Development, Mentoring & Coaching, Technical Direction, Cross-Functional Leadership, Executive Communication

**Reliability & Operations:** Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), SLI / SLO / Error Budgets, Incident & Problem Management, On-Call Strategy, Capacity Planning, Post-Incident Reviews, Toil Reduction

**Software & Automation:** Python, C# / .NET (working), PowerShell, Bash, Java (working), Go (concepts),

Automated Testing

**Distributed Systems & Cloud:** Large-Scale Distributed Systems, High-Availability Architecture, Microsoft Azure, AWS / GCP (concepts), Kubernetes (AKS/EKS/GKE), Docker, Scalability & Performance

**Observability:** Azure Monitor / App Insights, Kusto (KQL), Power BI, Grafana, Metrics / Logs / Traces, OpenTelemetry (concepts)

**CI/CD & IaC:** Azure DevOps, GitHub / Git, CI/CD Pipelines, Terraform, Bicep / ARM / YAML, Agile / Scrum / SAgile

**AI & Collaboration:** AI-Driven Incident Automation, GenAI Tooling (Copilot, Claude), R&D Partnership, Stakeholder Communication

## TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY

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Engineering Team Management & Mentoring — **Expert**

Site Reliability (SLI/SLO, Incident, On-Call) — **Expert**

Large-Scale Distributed Systems Operations — **Expert**

Software Engineering & Automation (Python / PowerShell) — **Expert**

Technical Direction & Architecture — **Advanced**

Observability (Azure Monitor / Kusto / Grafana) — **Advanced**

CI/CD & Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform / Bicep) — **Advanced**

AI-Driven Operational Automation — **Advanced**

Kubernetes (AKS/EKS/GKE) & Docker — **Advanced**

Java / Go — **Working Knowledge**

Cross-Functional & Executive Communication — **Expert**

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Site Reliability Lead / Engineering Manager — Xbox Cloud Services

Microsoft Corporation (via TechMahindra) | Redmond, WA | May 2021 - Present

Leads reliability engineering and a global team for a 24/7/365 high-availability cloud platform serving millions of users.

- Lead and mentor a global team of 15-32 engineers operating large-scale, mission-critical distributed services — own hiring, 1:1s, performance reviews, and career development while sustaining 100% SLA across 20+ services.
- Set technical direction for reliability and automation; define SLIs/SLOs, lead incident and problem management, on-call strategy, capacity planning, and post-incident reviews across a high-availability platform.
- Drove down operational toil through software engineering — built tools and automation in Python and PowerShell that eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ noisy alerts (~90% alert-fatigue reduction).
- Architected an AI-driven incident-automation platform reaching 30-35% auto-resolution; reduced mean resolution time 32% and lifted operational efficiency from 85% to 98%.
- Partner cross-functionally with R&D, product, and security to land complex multi-team initiatives and make new features reliable, scalable, secure, and easily deployable.
- Champion engineering excellence — observability, operational readiness, and CI/CD (Azure DevOps, GitHub); authored 175+ runbooks/playbooks and grew individual contributors into technical leads.

- Communicate reliability posture, SLA tracking, and incident history to senior leadership through executive reviews that drove investment and process decisions.

### **Azure Cloud Reliability & Platform Technical Lead — Customer Support Services**

*Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Redmond, WA | Nov 2016 - May 2021*

*Led a 15-engineer team operating high-availability cloud infrastructure and building developer tooling at scale.*

- Managed and grew a 15-engineer team; drove hiring, mentoring, and delivery of reliability and developer-productivity initiatives.
- Designed and architected monitoring, alerting, and automation (Python/PowerShell) that improved reliability and reduced manual operational effort across distributed Azure systems.
- Built CI/CD pipelines and Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Azure DevOps) with security, compliance, and cost guardrails; integrated observability into delivery pipelines.
- Partnered with R&D and product to improve deployability, performance, and serviceability of features across the SDLC.

### **Operations Lead — Azure Live Site Reliability**

*Microsoft Corporation (via Mindtree) | Hyderabad, India | May 2012 - Nov 2016*

*Led 12 senior + 20 engineers operating cloud platforms at 99.95%+ availability.*

- Led incident, problem, and change management for 100+ services; established SLA/SLO baselines, change governance, and on-call readiness.
- Built PowerShell/Python automation across provisioning, monitoring, and remediation saving thousands of manual hours.
- Mentored engineers into technical leads and drove repeatable, automated large-scale enterprise migration patterns.

### **Systems Analyst / Data Center Engineer**

*IBM (via Infosoft Inc) | Hammond, IN | Sep 2009 - Nov 2011*

*Infrastructure operations, automation, and scripting across enterprise environments.*

- Server builds, cluster configuration, and large-scale migrations; deployed monitoring and patches.
- Scripted repetitive operational tasks to improve consistency and reduce manual effort.

## **SELECTED PROJECTS & CASE STUDIES**

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**AI-Driven Incident Automation Platform** — Architected an AI incident agent (30-35% auto-resolution) integrating telemetry, alerting, and remediation workflows to drive down MTTR across a high-availability platform serving millions.

**SLI/SLO & Reliability Program** — Established SLI/SLO standards, on-call strategy, capacity planning, and post-incident reviews across 20+ services, sustaining 100% SLA.

**Toil-Reduction Tooling** — Built Python/PowerShell automation that eliminated 25,000+ stale incidents and 500+ noisy alerts, sharpening signal and freeing engineer time for higher-value work.

**Engineering Team Growth** — Hired, mentored, and grew global teams of 15-32 engineers, advancing individual contributors into technical leads through structured coaching and career development.

**CI/CD & IaC Platform** — Built CI/CD pipelines and Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Bicep, Azure DevOps) with security, compliance, and cost guardrails; integrated observability into delivery.

## LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

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- Led and mentored global teams of 15-32 engineers across the US and India, growing individual contributors into technical leads.
- Central escalation authority and SME for high-severity incidents, coordinating Security, Engineering, Product, and business teams under pressure.
- Ran 1:1s, performance reviews, onboarding, and targeted coaching/enablement plans; built psychologically safe, high-accountability culture.
- Synthesized incident and reliability data into executive reviews driving investment and process decisions.
- Early operationalizer of AI/automation in production support and operations; champion of continuous learning.

## CERTIFICATIONS

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- Microsoft Certified IT Professional — Azure Infrastructure Solutions (70-533, 70-534)
- Microsoft AZ-900 — Azure Fundamentals
- Google Cloud Computing Foundations
- Google — Introduction to Generative AI
- TechMahindra AI White Belt

## EDUCATION

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- Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Engineering, JNTU, Hyderabad (2008)

## PROFESSIONAL PHILOSOPHY

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*Great engineering leadership is reliability plus people: hire and grow strong engineers, set clear technical direction, measure what matters with SLIs/SLOs, and automate the toil so the team builds and operates systems that scale. Turn every incident into a lasting improvement, and lead with clarity, ownership, and trust.*